Teacher guide & answers

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Connect

Ask: What makes it hard to listen to someone? Introduce Michael as an imagined child, not a Bible character. Let children name distractions without shaming them.

Loved first

Read Matthew 6:6 and 1 John 4:19. Explain: the Father welcomes personal relationship, not a performance. Read Romans 5:8: Christ died for sinners. Prayer does not buy love or salvation. “In secret” means away from an audience, not hiding unsafe secrets from trusted adults.

Investigate Jesus’ example

Read Mark 1:35 and explain “desolate.” Children mark the actual verse with three different pencil marks. Read Luke 6:12–13; reconstruct the order and point to the supporting words. Jesus prayed before choosing the twelve. Children need sleep; this is not a command to stay awake. Plan around Michael’s game and breakfast, then explain why the plan helps.

Deduce, explain, apply

Read Luke 11:1 in full. Teach thanks, help and forgiveness. The three-friend puzzle is invented, not a Bible account. Each category is used once. Model eliminating one impossible choice, then let children solve and justify. Ask what Joseph can do after asking for help. Prayer supports obedience; it is not magic or a performance.

Joy and response

Read Psalm 63:3 and 1 Thessalonians 5:17. God’s steadfast love is His faithful love. Pray during ordinary life; quiet morning time is a helpful rhythm, not the only valid time. Color and complete one personal plan. Accept drawings or dictated answers.

Pray together

Invite voluntary one-sentence thanks or requests. Passing is fine. Return to Michael: what changed? Encourage a short, parent-supported quiet time tomorrow, without promises of prizes or perfect days.

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Page 2 · Mark the evidence

Circle “very early in the morning, while it was still dark”; box “a desolate place”; underline “he prayed”. Accept a larger time phrase including “And rising”. All marks belong in the printed verse, not in a separate matching list.

Page 2 · Restore the order

Numbers beside the printed events: 3, 1, 2. First the mountain, then prayer through the night, then choosing the twelve when day came. Have children point to “all night” and “when day came”.

Page 2 · Make a workable plan

Example: turn off the game, sit on the bedroom chair, and pray before breakfast. Why: fewer distractions help Michael pay attention to his Father. Also accept a short prayer now and quiet time after breakfast. Do not make prayer compete with helping the family. Drawings or dictated plans count.

Page 3 · One solution

Michael — morning — thanks. Rosie — evening — forgiveness. Joseph — afternoon — help. Clues 3 and 4 leave help for Joseph; clue 2 puts him in the afternoon. Clue 1 then puts Michael in the morning and Rosie in the evening. Thanks remains for Michael.

Page 3 · Act on the prayer

Example: Joseph asks God for help, then speaks gently, shares, or apologizes instead of snapping. Accept other concrete kind actions. A puzzle solution does not earn God’s love. These are three invented prayers, not a rule limiting anyone to one prayer or one topic each day.

Support and discussion

Younger children: adult reads; child circles choices, draws a plan or dictates. Older children: eliminate choices and justify each row. Ask: can Rosie pray again in the morning? Yes—prayer is welcome anytime. Personal prayer is not a performance. Page 4 responses are personal, not graded.

Sources · ESV

https://www.bible.com/bible/59/MAT.6.6.ESV

https://www.bible.com/bible/59/MRK.1.35.ESV

https://www.bible.com/bible/59/MRK.1.36-38.ESV

https://www.bible.com/bible/59/LUK.6.12-13.ESV

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